

# Alex Rivera

Backend & Distributed Systems Engineer — projecting toward Staff Platform Engineer

alex.rivera@example.com

+1 (555) 014-2288

github.com/example

Bristol, UK

PROJECTION — TARGET STATE 1 MARCH 2027

NOT A RECORD OF EXPERIENCE

## SUMMARY

Backend engineer with six years on high-throughput payment infrastructure, moving deliberately toward platform and reliability ownership. The lines below marked *Projected* are not yet true; each one is earned by a dated Milestone in the accompanying roadmap, and each Milestone names third-party-checkable Evidence.

## EXPERIENCE

### Senior Software Engineer, Meridian Payments

Mar 2022 — Mar 2027

- Owned the settlement ledger service handling 4.2M transactions per day at p99 < 90 ms.
- Led the migration of the ledger from a single Postgres primary to a sharded topology, cutting peak write contention by 61% — framed for platform ownership rather than feature delivery. **REFRAMED**
- Built the idempotency layer that eliminated duplicate-capture incidents entirely across two peak seasons.
- Published *meridian-shardkit*, an open-source Postgres resharding toolkit, and drove it to first external production adopter. **PROJECTED**
- Ran the service's first formal error-budget policy, with SLOs published and reviewed monthly by the platform group. **PROJECTED**
- Mentored three engineers through their first on-call rotations; wrote the runbook set still in use.

### Software Engineer, Northgate Logistics

Jul 2019 — Feb 2022

- Rewrote the route-optimisation batch pipeline in Go, taking a nightly 6-hour job to 38 minutes.
- Designed the event schema that eleven downstream teams consumed — restated as interface stewardship, the scope Staff roles are judged on. **REFRAMED**
- Introduced contract tests between the dispatch and billing services, ending a recurring class of release rollbacks.
- Ran the incident review process for the logistics group for eighteen months.

### Junior Engineer, Fenwick Analytics

Sep 2018 — Jun 2019

- Maintained the ingestion connectors for eight third-party data vendors.
- Cut the nightly ETL failure rate from roughly one in four runs to under one in fifty.

## OPEN SOURCE & WRITING

- Merged three contributions to the Vitess resharding path, including a fix to the vreplication catch-up loop. **PROJECTED**
- Wrote a five-part series on online resharding without downtime; the first part reached the front page of Lobsters. **PROJECTED**
- Gave a 25-minute talk on error-budget policy at a regional SRE meetup, recording published. **PROJECTED**
- Long-standing maintainer of *pgbench-scenarios*, a small load-shape library with 340 stars.

## SKILLS

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|               |                                                                                         |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LANGUAGES     | Go, Python, SQL, TypeScript, a working amount of Rust                                   |
| DATA          | PostgreSQL (incl. logical replication, partitioning), Vitess, Redis, Kafka, ClickHouse  |
| PLATFORM      | Kubernetes, Terraform, ArgoCD, GitHub Actions, Nix for dev shells                       |
| OBSERVABILITY | Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, error-budget and SLO practice                       |
| PRACTICE      | Incident review, capacity planning, design review facilitation, on-call rotation design |

## CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA), certification id published on the Linux Foundation directory. **PROJECTED**
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect — Professional. **PROJECTED**
- PostgreSQL 14 Associate (EDB), 2023.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>meridian-shardkit</b> 2026—27                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>ledger-fuzz</b> 2024—                                                                                                                                 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Online resharding toolkit for Postgres: cutover orchestration, dual-write verification, and a rollback path that has been exercised in anger. <b>PROJECTED</b></li><li>• Documented against a public benchmark suite so adopters can reproduce the numbers. <b>PROJECTED</b></li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Property-based fuzzer for double-entry ledger invariants; found four latent bugs in internal services.</li></ul> |
| <b>pgbench-scenarios</b> 2021—                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>runbook-lint</b> 2023—                                                                                                                                |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• A library of realistic load shapes for Postgres benchmarking; used in two published papers.</li><li>• Maintained with a monthly release cadence and a documented compatibility policy.</li></ul>                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Static checks for operational runbooks: every step must name a verification and a rollback.</li></ul>            |

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#### STAMP REPEAT PROBE

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